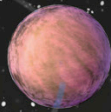
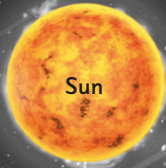


Days and years

All planets spin. The time each one takes to spin once is called a day. The time taken for a planet to go all the way around the Sun is a year. Days and years are different lengths on different planets.

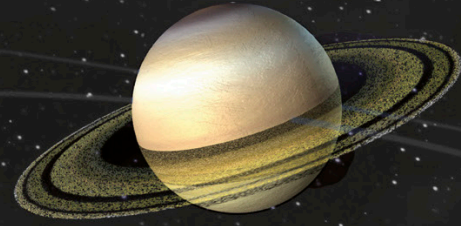
Mercury is the smallest planet and lies closest to the Sun.



Venus is the brightest, hottest planet. It has an incredibly thick atmosphere.



Earth is the only planet with an atmosphere that can support life.



Saturn has rings made of ice, dust, and rock.



Fire in the sky

There are many other objects in space. Comets are chunks of ice, rock, and dust. Meteors are lumps of rock that burn up as they enter the Earth's atmosphere. We see them as shooting stars.



Neptune



Uranus



Saturn



Jupiter



Sun

How big?

All the planets are tiny in comparison with the Sun, but the outer planets are much bigger than the four closest to it. The Sun is 100 times wider than the Earth!